

The team that makes the yes sustainable — and the template the next reserve inherits.

A community development contract at \$60k+/month is a real inflection point. It only stays a yes if the practitioner's days with the kids stay sacred, the on-the-ground execution doesn't depend on one tired person, and the band gets infrastructure that outlasts the engagement. Below: the operating structure, the financial model with a 35% reinvestment markup, and the path from one pilot to a repeatable template.

THE COST BASIS · LOADED MONTHLY · SCENARIO A FLOOR

Role	What it absorbs	Monthly	Adds at
Practitioner / Lead	Engagement owner; strategic + field work	\$14,000	A
Operations Manager	Phone, depot, day-of fires; 807 ops + Deer Lake distribution <i>(folds with the Food Handler line below into the slides' \$8.5k Hub Operator headline; broken out here so the A-floor cost basis is auditable line-by-line)</i>	\$8,500	A
IT/Tech	Server fleet, privacy phones, transparency stack, store IT	\$9,500	A
Bookkeeper / Admin	Invoicing, contracts, CRA, agency back office	\$2,500	A
Food Handler	Headwaters-owned, embedded at the Deer Lake store from Day 1: salt batches, 807-branded piecework, kitchen/shop tidy, food & supplies inventory <i>(folds with the Operations Manager line above into the slides' \$8.5k Hub Operator headline; broken out here so the A-floor cost basis is auditable line-by-line)</i>	\$5,000	A
CD Associate	Pilot #2 readiness; community-facing engagement	\$7,500	B
Junior Analyst / Field	Data, household price lookups, fieldwork	\$6,500	B
Senior Engineer #2 + Outreach + Trainer	Server resilience, pilot #2 sourcing, council training	\$26,500	C
Life supports + overhead	Cleaner, tutor, handyman, tooling/SaaS, recurring tech ops (statutory buffer absorbed by Food Handler at the floor)	\$5,700	A
Facilities — aggregation hub	Dad-warehouse · \$2,200 rent + utilities, all-in (garage + house-next-door priced as expansion options; see /lease-tooling)	\$3,000	A
Cost basis	A · floor → B · recommended → C · scale	\$48,200 / \$69,700 / \$99,100	

BILL SCENARIOS — COST BASIS + REINVESTMENT MARKUP (35% TARGET)

Scenario	Cost basis	Reinvestment	Bill / month	Bridge needed
A · floor	\$48,200	\$11,800 (24%)	\$60,000	~\$96k
B · recommended	\$69,700	\$20,300 (29%)	\$90,000	~\$181k
C · scale	\$99,100	\$25,900 (26%)	\$125,000	~\$258k

Cost basis includes the Dad-warehouse aggregation hub (\$3k/mo all-in; see /lease-tooling for the related-party documentation). Bridge = M2 trough on a net-60 cycle (two months of cost basis + day-one tech CAPEX of \$0 / \$42k / \$60k). Recovered when the last two invoices clear. 35% reinvestment is the target; the actual % drifts as the cost basis grows.

WHAT THE 35% REINVESTMENT BUYS (RECOMMENDED ASK)

Destination	Year 1	What it ships
Computers and phones	~\$60k	9 servers we run ourselves, 6 secure phones, 8 work laptops, plus the networking gear that ties them together
Software subscriptions	~\$24k	Open-records dashboard hosting, mapping, secure messaging, project tracker, payroll
Training and the written guide	~\$36k	Indigenous-services certifications, conferences, hours spent writing the guide for running the store
Saved for the next reserve	~\$172k	Kept in its own account so the next reserve can start without waiting for a grant

WHAT IT COSTS THE NEXT RESERVE • CROSS-RESERVE PRICING

DEER LAKE • LAYER 1 SOFTWARE-ONLY CONTRACT
(SIGNED TODAY)

\$420,000 /yr • \$35,000/mo • upgrade ask: \$90,000/mo

full-stack agency (absorbs this line)

~\$148.5k install (12-week stint, ~30 on-site + ~24 remote days) + ~\$22.5k travel pass-through* + \$30k first-year retainer ≈ ~\$201k Y1 all-in. Same headline as the Deer Lake deck's *First reserve, then the next* slide — kept here so the band council reads the symmetry to Deer Lake's Layer-1 software contract (\$420,000/yr) the moment they print.

* Planning estimate (Deer Lake corridor: ~\$1,000/return × 12 wks + \$250/night × 30 + \$100/day × 30). The receiving reserve replaces this with their own corridor's costs; travel is pass-through at cost, not in the practitioner's fee.

RESERVE #2 • Y1 ALL-IN STICKER (PLANNING ESTIMATE)

~\$201,000 install + travel + Y1 retainer

SALT COST-CENTRE • SALT-01 NET CONTRIBUTION TO THE AGENCY P&L

PLANNING BASELINE • PRE-FILING

\$5,083 / mo (~\$61k/yr)

Planning baseline ~\$61k/yr net (~\$5.1k/mo) at wholesale CM 63%. Once the bookkeeper files a monthly close at /salt-monthly-close, the live figure replaces the baseline here.

WHOLESALE CM% • FLOOR 50%

63% • planning

STATUS

PRE-FILING

THE ASK

A monthly retainer of **\$90,000** against a 12-month engagement, reviewed at month 6, plus acknowledgement that **~\$181,000 of bridge capital** is required on day one to cover team payroll plus tech CAPEX (cost basis includes the Dad-warehouse aggregation hub at \$3k/mo all-in; see /lease-tooling) before the first net-60 invoice clears. 35% is the target reinvestment line — audited annually; the actual % drifts as the cost basis grows.

NET-POSITIVE ACCOUNTABILITY

The markup is upfront. The receipts are public: **procurement savings delivered**, time returned to band staff, transparency tools shipped & adopted, capacity built locally, **year-end value-delivered audit**. If the value delivered doesn't beat the markup, we credit forward.